

Space probes

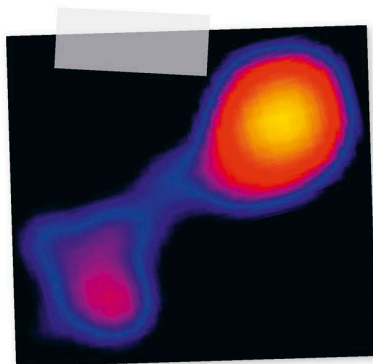
Earth's atmosphere stops some information from space reaching us. To overcome this problem, astronomers send out machines, called space probes, to get a closer look at the planets. Other spacecraft, called satellites, orbit Earth above the atmosphere and look out into space.



The Hubble Space Telescope orbits Earth. It looks out into space, seeing farther than any of the Earth-based telescopes.

There are observatories on mountain tops all around the world.

Special telescopes, called radio telescopes, listen to the stars.



Seeing into a star

Different tools look at the stars in different ways. X-ray satellites take X-ray pictures. A star may not shine very brightly, but an X-ray picture might show that there is a lot of activity in the star and that it has lots of energy.

A great help

Computers control telescopes, satellites, and space probes, and also help astronomers work out what they have seen. In modern astronomy, computers are just as important as telescopes.

